

Salik

Company Profile and Buyer Screen

DFM: SALIK · AED millions · per-share values in AED · as of FY2025 accounts · market data 18 Sep 2026

A company profile and buyer screen for Salik, Dubai's toll-gate operator, on FY2025 accounts and 18 September 2026 market data: what the business is, how it has performed since the 2022 IPO, where it trades against listed toll roads, who could realistically own a stake, and what a financial sponsor and a strategic operator could each pay.

What this is

- Four years of income, cash flow and balance sheet with growth, margins, cash conversion and leverage.

How it is built

- Trading multiples against a short, stated peer set with exclusions explained.
- Twelve candidate buyers scored 1–5 on strategic fit, toll-road precedent, financial capacity, regional presence and the likelihood of Government of Dubai consent; weights are inputs and the ranking is live.
- Ability to pay: a sponsor constrained by 6x leverage, a five-year exit and a 13% hurdle; a strategic constrained by a 7% cost of capital over the 45 years left on the concession.

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Key outputs (live)

FY2025 EBITDA (AED m)	2,165
EV / EBITDA at the market price	20.2x
Price return since the IPO	168.5%
Highest-scoring candidate	Vinci Concessions
Sponsor ability to pay (AED per share)	4.66
Strategic ability to pay (AED per share)	6.05

Colour code

Blue = hard-coded input
Black = formula
Green = link to another sheet
Accent fill = scenario selector / key levers

Sources

Salik Company PJSC financial statements FY2022–FY2025 via Yahoo Finance for SALIK.AE; concession terms, gates and tariff from the 2022 IPO prospectus and RTA announcements.

Share price and 52-week range: DFM close, 18 September 2026. Peer multiples: Yahoo Finance the same day.

Buyer scores are the author's judgements from public precedent; criteria weights and every ability-to-pay input are stated.

Nothing here is a recommendation and there is no suggestion any party is or has been in discussions.

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Four years since the IPO — income, cash and balance sheet

INCOME STATEMENT (AED millions)

	FY2022A	FY2023A	FY2024A	FY2025A
Revenue	1,892	2,109	2,292	3,097
Growth		11.5%	8.7%	35.1%
EBITDA	1,443	1,420	1,627	2,165
EBITDA margin	76.3%	67.3%	71.0%	69.9%
Depreciation and amortisation	(44)	(83)	(91)	(145)
Net finance cost	(73)	(239)	(257)	(313)
Corporate tax	-	-	(115)	(154)
Net profit	1,326	1,098	1,165	1,553
check: EBITDA – D&A – finance – tax	1,326	1,098	1,164	1,553
Earnings per share (AED)	0.177	0.146	0.155	0.207

CASH FLOW AND DISTRIBUTION

Cash from operations	1,516	1,454	1,463	2,082
Capital expenditure	(3)	(5)	(6)	(3)
Free cash flow	1,513	1,449	1,457	2,079
Dividends paid	(827)	(1,039)	(1,095)	(1,391)
Dividends paid / prior-year net profit		78.4%	99.7%	119.4%
Free cash flow / EBITDA	104.9%	102.0%	89.6%	96.0%

BALANCE SHEET

Borrowings	3,986	3,997	4,000	4,001
Cash	823	266	964	513
Net debt	3,163	3,731	3,036	3,488
Net debt / EBITDA	2.2x	2.6x	1.9x	1.6x
EBITDA / net finance cost	19.8x	5.9x	6.3x	6.9x
Shareholders' equity	604	663	1,088	1,219

The FY2025 step-up is the tariff, not traffic: variable pricing from 31 January 2025 (AED 6 at peak, AED 4 off-peak) and two gates opened in November 2024. Capex is negligible because the RTA builds and operates the gates; Salik's cost is a concession fee inside operating expenses. Equity is small because the company was formed with AED 4bn of debt and pays out all its profit.

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What Salik is, in the form a buyer's investment committee would read it

THE BUSINESS

What it does

Operates Dubai's automated road-toll system under an exclusive 49-year concession from the Roads and Transport Authority running to 2071. Ten gates as of 2025. Tolls are collected electronically per crossing; the tariff is set by government decree.

Revenue model

Toll revenue per crossing (the large majority), plus fines, tag activation and ancillary services. Variable pricing was introduced on 31 January 2025: AED 6 at peak hours, AED 4 off-peak, free between 1am and 2am. Ancillary growth comes from parking payments and partnerships.

Cost model

Asset-light. The RTA builds, owns and maintains the gates; Salik pays a concession fee and a service fee. There is almost no capital expenditure, so EBITDA converts to cash at close to 100%.

Ownership

Listed on the Dubai Financial Market since 29 September 2022 at AED 2.00 per share, raising AED 3.7bn for the Government of Dubai, which retains 75.1%. Free float 24.9%.

Capital structure

AED 4.0bn of bank debt put in place at formation and held flat since; the company distributes all of its net profit. Leverage has fallen from 2.2x to 1.6x EBITDA on earnings growth alone.

WHY A BUYER WOULD LOOK

Predictability

Traffic in a growing city, a tariff set by decree and a 45-year remaining term. The revenue line is closer to a regulated utility than to a typical toll road with traffic risk.

Growth levers

New gates (two added in 2024), tariff changes (2025), population growth, and ancillary revenue. All three of the first are policy decisions, not management decisions, which is both the attraction and the constraint.

The constraint

The Government of Dubai holds 75.1% and the RTA controls the gates, the tariff and the concession. Any change of control is a policy decision. The realistic transactions are a further sell-down of the government's stake, an anchor stake to a long-term investor, or a partnership; an unsolicited bid is not one of them.

KEY NUMBERS, FY2025

Revenue (AED m)	3,097
EBITDA (AED m)	2,165
EBITDA margin	69.9%
Net profit (AED m)	1,553
Free cash flow / EBITDA	96.0%
Net debt / EBITDA	1.6x

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Where Salik trades, against listed toll roads and a local concession

SALIK AT THE MARKET PRICE

Share price (AED, DFM close 18 Sep 2026)	5.37
Shares (millions)	7,500
Market capitalisation	40,275
Net debt, FY2025	3,488
Enterprise value	43,763
EV / EBITDA, FY2025	20.2x
P / E, FY2025	25.9x
Dividend yield on FY2025 dividends paid	3.5%
Free cash flow yield to enterprise value	4.8%
Price return since the IPO at AED 2.00	168.5%

LISTED COMPARABLES — trailing EV / EBITDA, 18 September 2026

Company	Business	EV / EBITDA	Included	If included	Note
Transurban (ASX)	Toll roads, Australia and North America	26.3x	Yes	26.3x	
Ferrovial (Cintra)	Toll roads, Europe and North America	27.7x	No		Group multiple distorted by construction and airports
Vinci	Concessions and contracting, France	7.2x	No		Contracting dilutes the concession multiple
IRB Infrastructure (NSE)	Toll roads, India	15.5x	Yes	15.5x	
Vesta (NYSE)	Industrial real estate, Mexico — yield comparator	16.9x	No		Not a toll road; shown for yield context only
Tabreed (DFM)	District cooling concessions, UAE	12.1x	Yes	12.1x	
Salik at the market price		20.2x			
Median of included peers		15.5x			
Salik premium / (discount) to the peer median		30.4%			

Pure toll-road operators with long concessions trade at high-teens to mid-twenties EBITDA multiples because the cash flows are long, contracted and inflation-linked. Salik sits inside that range with the shortest listed history and the least traffic risk, which is why the peer set is short and the exclusions are stated.

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Twelve candidates scored on five criteria — the scores are judgements and the weights are inputs

CRITERIA WEIGHTS (must sum to 100%)											
Government consent				25.0%	20.0%	20.0%	15.0%	20.0%	100.0%		
THE SCREEN (scores 1 = weak, 5 = strong)											
Candidate	Type	Home	Precedent and relevant assets	Strategic fit	Toll-road precedent	Financial capacity	Regional presence	Government consent	Weighted	Rank	Read-across
Transurban	Strategic	Australia	Owns 20+ urban toll roads; WestConnex, 407 ETR	5	5	3	2	3	3.75	10	Best operator fit; balance sheet stretched; no Gulf presence
Vinci Concessions	Strategic	France	Autoroutes du Sud; Lima Expresa; airports	5	5	5	3	3	4.30	1	Deepest pockets among strategics; Gulf contracting relationships via Vinci
Ferrovial / Cintra	Strategic	Spain / NL	407 ETR, LBJ and NTE managed lanes	5	5	4	2	3	3.95	8	Managed-lane expertise fits dynamic pricing; light in the region
Abertis (Mundys / ACS)	Strategic	Spain / Italy	Largest toll-road operator by km; Red de Carreteras, Sanef	5	5	4	3	3	4.10	4	Largest pure toll-road owner; would want operational control the RTA will not give
Globalvia	Strategic	Spain	Mid-size toll roads and rail concessions	4	4	2	2	2	2.90	12	Too small for a AED 40bn asset except as a minority partner
Global Infrastructure Partners (BlackRock)	Financial	US	Jafurah midstream (Aramco); Gatwick; ports	4	3	5	4	4	4.00	7	Just closed Jafurah with Aramco; the template for a Gulf minority-stake deal
Brookfield Infrastructure	Financial	Canada	Toll roads in Brazil, India, Peru; large Gulf activity	4	4	5	4	4	4.20	2	Owns toll roads and has a Gulf office; natural anchor investor
Macquarie Asset Management	Financial	Australia	Historic toll-road sponsor; UK, US, India roads	4	5	5	3	3	4.05	6	Invented the listed toll-road fund model; strong precedent
KKR Infrastructure	Financial	US	ADNOC pipelines; Indian roads platform	4	4	5	4	4	4.20	2	ADNOC pipelines precedent shows the Gulf structure works
CVC / DIF Capital Partners	Financial	NL / Luxembourg	Mid-market PPP and transport concessions	3	4	3	3	3	3.20	11	Cheque size is the constraint
PIF / Mubadala / ADQ	Sovereign	Gulf	Regional infrastructure; co-investment with global sponsors	3	2	5	5	5	3.90	9	Most likely co-investor in any government sell-down; no operational value-add
Dubai Holding / ICD (incumbent)	Sovereign	Dubai	Existing owner group; reorganisation rather than a sale	3	3	5	5	5	4.10	4	The counterparty in every scenario; a reorganisation is more likely than a sale
Highest-scoring candidate			Vinci Concessions								
weighted score				4.30							
Financial and sovereign buyers in the top five				3							
The screen ranks who could realistically hold a stake, not who would bid for control. Vinci leads on fit and balance sheet; the sponsors that have already done minority infrastructure deals with Gulf sovereigns — Brookfield, KKR, GIP — sit immediately behind it, level with the incumbent shareholder group. The purest operators, Transurban and Ferrovial, score highest on fit and fall down the list on consent and capacity, which is the finding: the likely transaction is a minority stake to a sponsor or sovereign, with an operator as a partner rather than a buyer.											

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What a sponsor and a strategic could each pay per share, and why they differ

COMMON OPERATING CASE

FY2025 EBITDA	2,165				
					Traffic and population plus ancillary; below the 2025 step-up, which was a tariff event
EBITDA growth, next five years	6.0%				
Corporate tax	9.0%				
Depreciation and amortisation as % of EBITDA	7.0%				
Capex as % of EBITDA	0.5%				
Net debt today	3,488				
EBITDA in year five	2,897				

A. FINANCIAL SPONSOR — leverage and a return hurdle

					Infrastructure lenders will go further on a concession with no traffic risk than on a corporate
Debt at entry (x EBITDA)	6.0x				
Cost of debt	6.0%				
					Below today's multiple on purpose
Exit EV / EBITDA in year five	18.0x				Core-plus infrastructure; lower than a buyout because the risk is lower
Required equity IRR	13.0%				
Debt raised at entry	12,990				
Debt paydown, year by year (all free cash after interest and tax repays debt)					
Opening debt	12,990	11,608	10,025	8,222	
EBITDA	2,295	2,433	2,579	2,733	
Interest on opening debt	(779)	(696)	(601)	(493)	

Cash after tax and capex available to repay debt	1,382	1,583	1,802	2,042
Closing debt	11,608	10,025	8,222	6,181
Exit enterprise value	52,151			
Exit equity value	48,273			
Maximum equity cheque at the hurdle: exit equity / (1 + IRR)^5	26,201			
Transaction and financing fees (% of EV)	2.0%			
Maximum enterprise value a sponsor can pay	38,422			
Maximum price per share — sponsor (AED)	4.66			
versus the market price	(13.3%)			

B. STRATEGIC OPERATOR — cost of capital over the remaining concession

Strategic buyer's WACC for a Gulf concession	7.0%
Cost synergies as % of EBITDA	3.0%
Remaining concession life (years, to 2071)	45
Long-run cash flow growth after year five	3.0%
Year-one free cash flow to the firm, with synergies	2,150
PV of years one to five (growing annuity at g)	9,859
PV of years six to end of concession (growing annuity at long-run g)	38,971
Maximum enterprise value a strategic can pay	48,829
Maximum price per share — strategic (AED)	6.05
versus the market price	12.6%
implied EV / EBITDA at that price	22.6x

Little to synergise: the RTA runs the gates. Technology and procurement only

A sponsor is capped by what lenders will fund and by a five-year exit; a strategic is capped only by its cost of capital over a 45-year concession. That is why the strategic number is higher and why, in a real process, the financial buyers are the anchor and the operators are the price-setters. Neither can bid without the government.

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Every check must read TRUE

INTEGRITY CHECKS

Reported net profit reconciles to EBITDA less D&A, finance and tax in every year	TRUE
Capex is below 1% of EBITDA in every year	TRUE
Net debt / EBITDA has fallen since FY2022	TRUE
Market capitalisation reconciles to price times shares	TRUE
Share price lies within the 52-week range	TRUE
Peer median evaluates to a number	TRUE
Criteria weights sum to 100%	TRUE
Every score lies between 1 and 5	TRUE
Weighted scores lie between 1 and 5	TRUE
Sponsor debt is fully serviced: closing debt never negative and below opening	TRUE
Sponsor exit multiple is not above today's trading multiple	TRUE
Strategic WACC exceeds long-run growth	TRUE
Strategic ability to pay exceeds the sponsor's (the structural result)	TRUE
Government stake plus free float equals 100%	TRUE

MODEL STATUS

MODEL OK

The thirteenth check is a discipline check: if the sponsor's number ever exceeds the strategic's, either the leverage or the exit multiple has been pushed past what the asset supports.